TrueSum

P&L VARIANCE ANALYSIS · SAP BUSINESS ONE

Where did the profit go?

The Variance Command Center reads every journal line in your P&L and tells you what moved, when it moved, and what deserves a second look.



VARIANCE COMMAND CENTER
2026 EDITION

INSIDE: THE NORTHBRIDGE CASE
A FICTIONAL DISTRIBUTOR, JAN–SEP 2026 VS 2025

01 · THE QUESTION EVERY CONTROLLER GETS

Sales up 7.7%. Profit down 46%. Why?

CHANGE IN NET PROFIT · JAN–SEP

−368,319

Northbridge Supply Co. sold 678,601 more than last year. It still earned less. A trial-balance comparison shows the gap; it can't say where it came from. The Variance Command Center answers in the first screen, and every bar below opens the journal lines behind it.

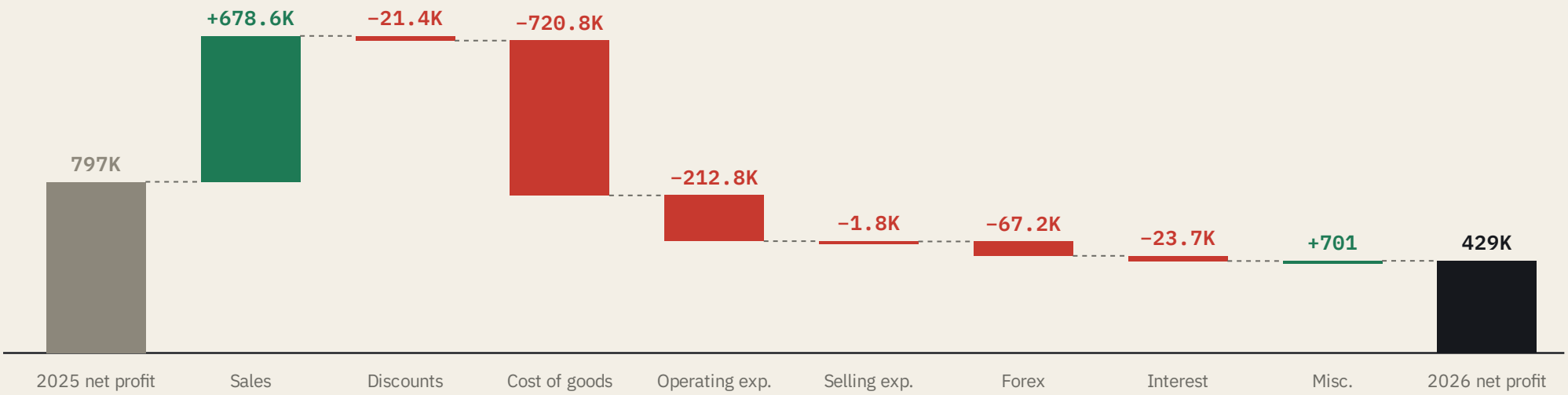


FIG. 1 · PROFIT BRIDGE. Each bar is one part of the P&L and its effect on net profit; the parts add back to −368,319 exactly. Cost of goods took more than the extra sales brought in.

NORTHBRIDGE SUPPLY CO. IS FICTIONAL. ALL FIGURES COME FROM THE DEMO DATASET.

02 · SIX LENSES ON ONE DATASET

One export. Six ways to read it.

Drop the SAP Business One export on the page and the whole year is live. Filters at the top apply everywhere: change the months, the comparison or the sections, and every lens recalculates from the same journal lines.

YEAR OVER YEAR · PERIOD VS PERIOD
MONTH CHIPS · YTD · H1 · H2 · Q1–Q4
OPERATING RESULT KEPT APART FROM FINANCING, TAX AND MISC.
CSV EXPORT FROM EVERY VIEW

01 p. 04
Overview
Headline KPIs, profit bridge and a P&L statement that comments on itself.

02 p. 05
Monthly Heatmap
Every G/L account by month, coloured by direction and size.

03 p. 08
Variance Explorer
Section to group to account to customer, with a status at every level.

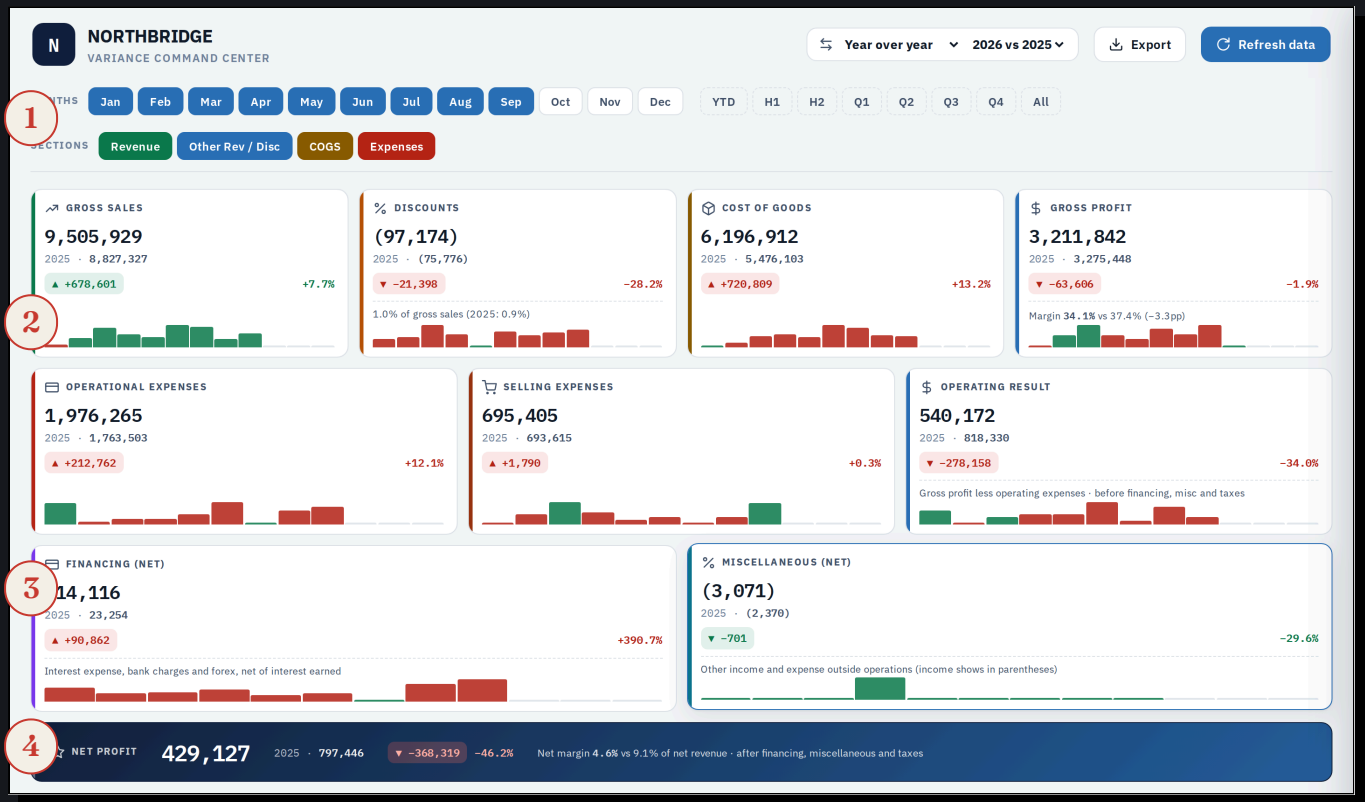
04 p. 09
Drill-down
Any number opens what happened, the monthly pattern and the journal lines.

05 p. 10
Audit Flags
Thirteen tests, six audit dimensions, every finding scored.

06 p. 11
Insights
Trading or bookkeeping? Origin mix, manual journals and run-rate.

MONTHLY HEATMAP · TOP 4 ACCOUNTS · Δ 2026 – 2025

	JAN	FEB	MAR	APR	MAY	JUN	JUL	AUG	SEP	TOTAL Δ
Sales - Inventory	-14.8K	+57.0K	+115.9K	+74.2K	+59.6K	+131.9K	+121.0K	+51.9K	+81.8K	+678.6K
Cost of Goods Sold	-10.7K	+31.7K	+68.9K	+69.3K	+60.5K	+138.7K	+126.3K	+76.1K	+63.8K	+624.6K
Sales Salaries Domestic		-361	+9.5K	+9.4K	+11.1K	+9.6K	+11.0K	+8.6K	+9.9K	+68.8K
Profit & Loss on Forex Trans	+11.8K	+7.1K	+6.1K	+8.3K	+2.7K	+4.2K	-5.1K	+13.9K	+18.2K	+67.2K



LENS 01

The whole P&L, before you scroll.

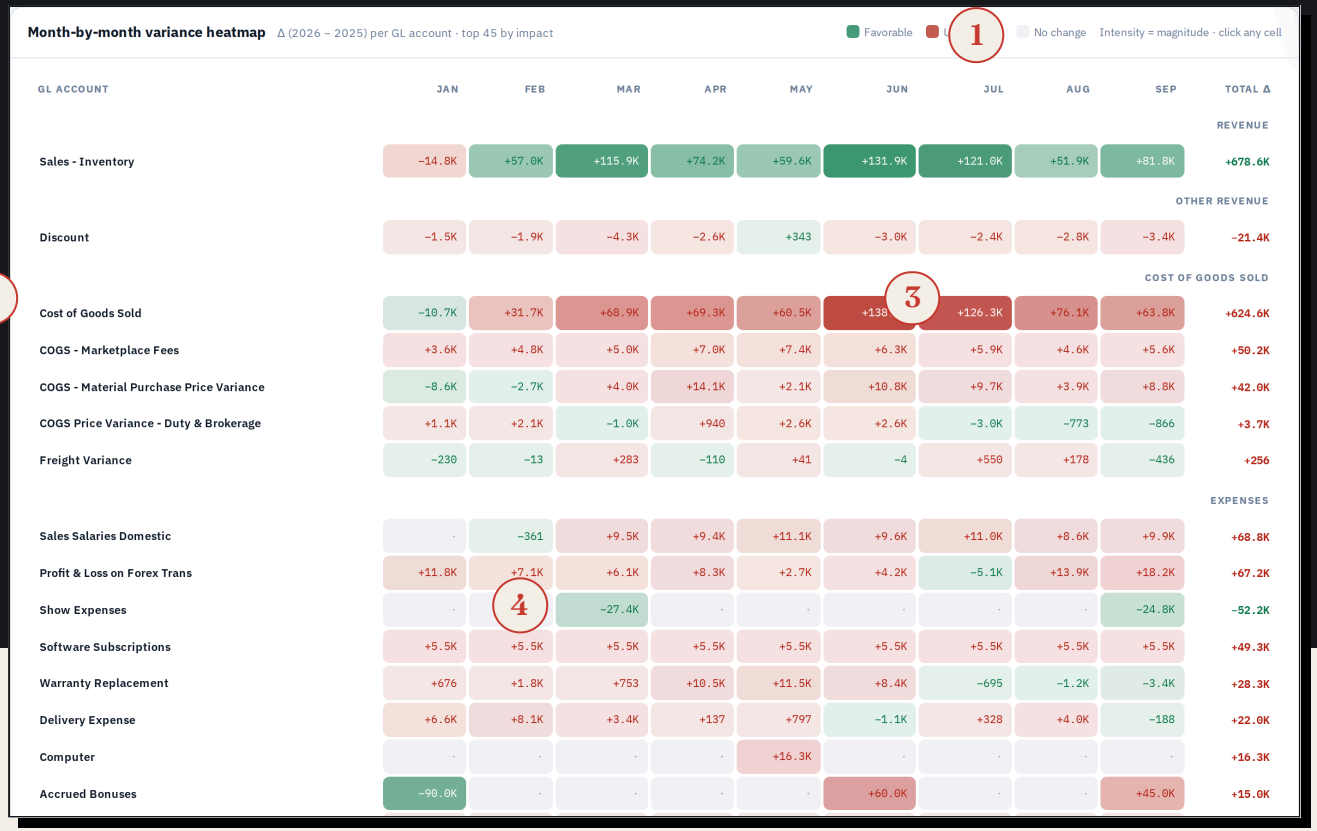
1. **Sales, discounts, cost of goods, gross profit.** Margin shown against last year.
2. **Operating and selling expenses** and the operating result, before financing and taxes.
3. **Financing and miscellaneous below the line,** so a forex swing never hides inside operations.
4. **Net profit and net margin.** Every card opens its breakdown.

FIG. 2 · HEADLINE CARDS WITH MONTHLY SPARKLINES, 2026 VS 2025

LENS 02

A variance has a date.

The year-to-date figure says what moved. The heat map says when. Each row is a G/L account, each cell a month: green helps profit, red hurts it, and the deeper the colour, the bigger the change.



1 **The legend.** Favourable is green whether it's more revenue or less cost.

2 **A red row is a run-rate problem.** Cost of goods is red in every month from April: something changed and stayed changed.

3 **A dark cell is a moment.** June and July carry the worst of it, which is where to start the questions.

4 **A lone cell in a quiet row is timing.** Show Expenses goes green in March because the 2025 dealer expo wasn't repeated.

FIG. 3 · THE TOOL'S HEATMAP ON THE DEMO DATA. EVERY CELL OPENS ITS JOURNAL LINES.

CASE NOTE

Margin didn't erode. It broke in April and got worse through the summer.

Year to date, gross margin is down 3.3 points. Spread over nine months that looks like slow price pressure. The monthly view says otherwise: flat until March, a step down in April, the worst in June and July.

The heatmap points at the same months in cost of goods, purchase price variance and marketplace fees. The audit register flags four of them for margin compression.

GROSS MARGIN BY MONTH · SHADED = FLAGGED FOR COMPRESSION

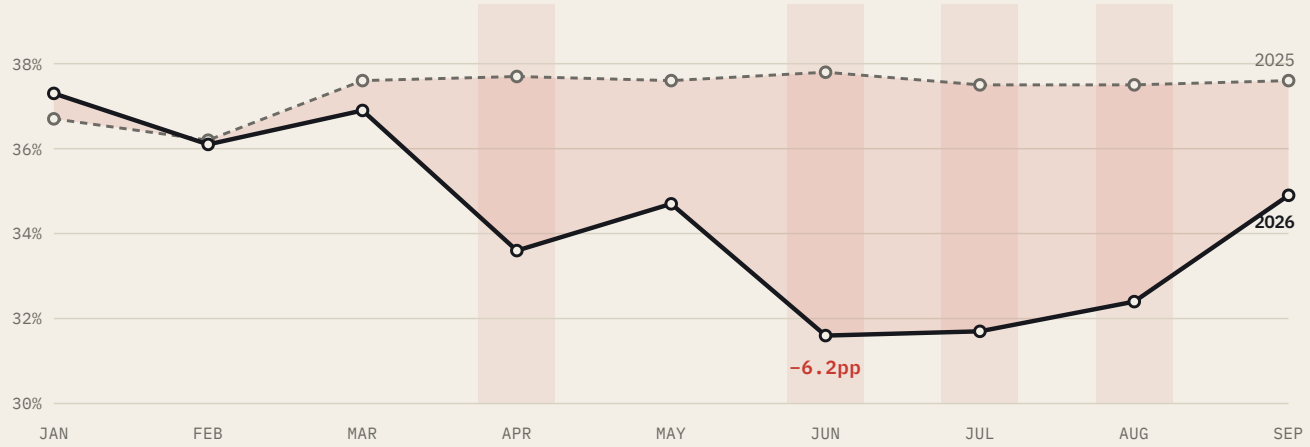
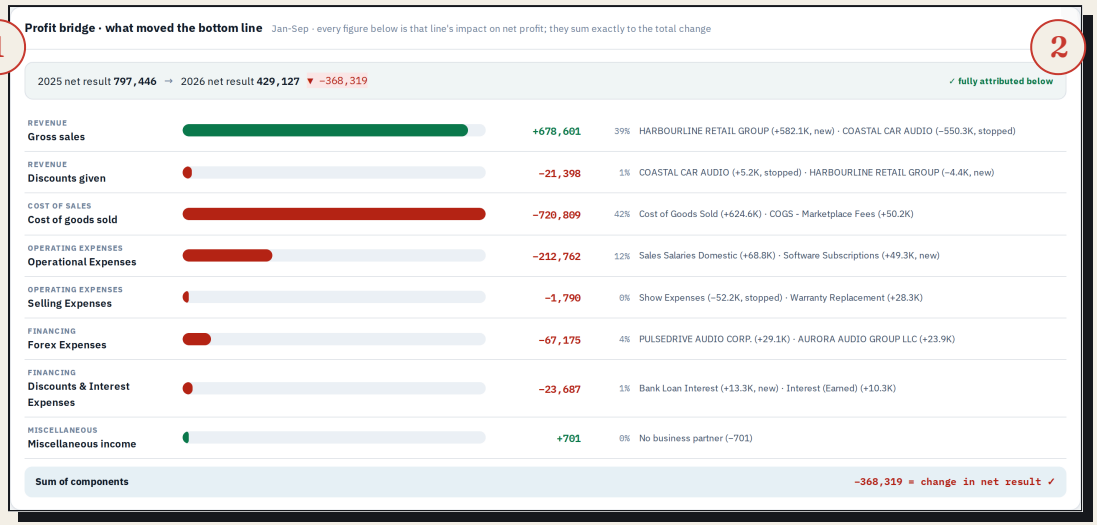


FIG. 4 · The red band is margin given up against the same month last year.

	JAN	FEB	MAR	APR	MAY	JUN	JUL	AUG	SEP	TOTAL Δ
Sales - Inventory	−14.8K	+57.0K	+115.9K	+74.2K	+59.6K	+131.9K	+121.0K	+51.9K	+81.8K	+678.6K
Cost of Goods Sold	−10.7K	+31.7K	+68.9K	+69.3K	+60.5K	+138.7K	+126.3K	+76.1K	+63.8K	+624.6K
Sales Salaries Domestic		−361	+9.5K	+9.4K	+11.1K	+9.6K	+11.0K	+8.6K	+9.9K	+68.8K
Profit & Loss on Forex Trans	+11.8K	+7.1K	+6.1K	+8.3K	+2.7K	+4.2K	−5.1K	+13.9K	+18.2K	+67.2K
Show Expenses			−27.4K						−24.8K	−52.2K
COGS - Marketplace Fees	+3.6K	+4.8K	+5.0K	+7.0K	+7.4K	+6.3K	+5.9K	+4.6K	+5.6K	+50.2K

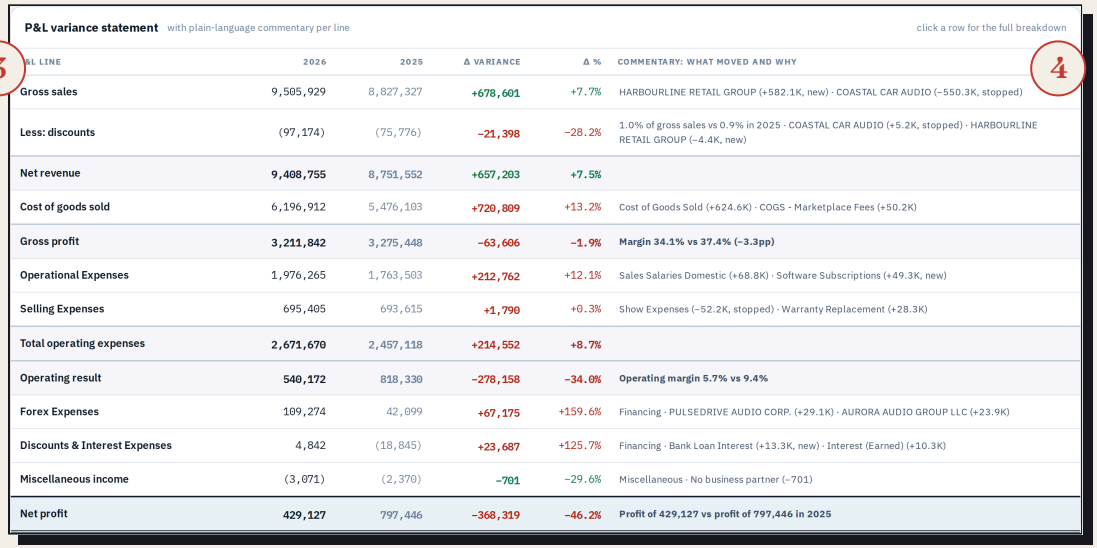
FIG. 5 · Six largest movements by account, Δ 2026 − 2025, drawn from the demo dataset.



Profit bridge · what moved the bottom line Jan-Sep · every figure below is that line's impact on net profit; they sum exactly to the total change

2025 net result **797,446** → 2026 net result **429,127** ▼ −368,319 ✓ fully attributed below

REVENUE Gross sales	+678,601	39%	HARBOURLINE RETAIL GROUP (+582.1K, new) · COASTAL CAR AUDIO (−550.3K, stopped)
REVENUE Discounts given	−21,398	1%	COASTAL CAR AUDIO (+5.2K, stopped) · HARBOURLINE RETAIL GROUP (−4.4K, new)
COST OF SALES Cost of goods sold	−720,809	42%	Cost of Goods Sold (+624.6K) · COGS - Marketplace Fees (+50.2K)
OPERATING EXPENSES Operational Expenses	−212,762	12%	Sales Salaries Domestic (+68.8K) · Software Subscriptions (+49.3K, new)
OPERATING EXPENSES Selling Expenses	−1,790	0%	Show Expenses (−52.2K, stopped) · Warranty Replacement (+28.3K)
FINANCING Forex Expenses	−67,175	4%	PULSEDRIVE AUDIO CORP. (+29.1K) · AURORA AUDIO GROUP LLC (+23.9K)
FINANCING Discounts & Interest Expenses	−23,687	1%	Bank Loan Interest (+13.3K, new) · Interest (Earned) (+10.3K)
MISCELLANEOUS Miscellaneous income	+701	0%	No business partner (−701)
Sum of components	−368,319 = change in net result ✓		



P&L variance statement with plain-language commentary per line — click a row for the full breakdown

P&L LINE	2026	2025	Δ VARIANCE	Δ %	COMMENTARY: WHAT MOVED AND WHY
Gross sales	9,505,929	8,827,327	+678,601	+7.7%	HARBOURLINE RETAIL GROUP (+582.1K, new) · COASTAL CAR AUDIO (−550.3K, stopped)
Less: discounts	(97,174)	(75,776)	−21,398	−28.2%	1.0% of gross sales vs 0.9% in 2025 · COASTAL CAR AUDIO (+5.2K, stopped) · HARBOURLINE RETAIL GROUP (−4.4K, new)
Net revenue	**9,408,755**	8,751,552	+657,203	+7.5%	
Cost of goods sold	6,196,912	5,476,103	+720,809	+13.2%	Cost of Goods Sold (+624.6K) · COGS - Marketplace Fees (+50.2K)
Gross profit	**3,211,842**	3,275,448	−63,606	−1.9%	**Margin 34.1% vs 37.4% (−3.3pp)**
Operational Expenses	1,976,265	1,763,503	+212,762	+12.1%	Sales Salaries Domestic (+68.8K) · Software Subscriptions (+49.3K, new)
Selling Expenses	695,405	693,615	+1,790	+0.3%	Show Expenses (−52.2K, stopped) · Warranty Replacement (+28.3K)
Total operating expenses	**2,671,670**	2,457,118	+214,552	+8.7%	
Operating result	**540,172**	818,330	−278,158	−34.0%	**Operating margin 5.7% vs 9.4%**
Forex Expenses	109,274	42,099	+67,175	+159.6%	Financing · PULSEDRIVE AUDIO CORP. (+29.1K) · AURORA AUDIO GROUP LLC (+23.9K)
Discounts & Interest Expenses	4,842	(18,845)	+23,687	+125.7%	Financing · Bank Loan Interest (+13.3K, new) · Interest (Earned) (+10.3K)
Miscellaneous income	(3,071)	(2,370)	−701	−29.6%	Miscellaneous · No business partner (−701)
Net profit	**429,127**	797,446	−368,319	−46.2%	**Profit of 429,127 vs profit of 797,446 in 2025**

LENS 01, CONTINUED

The commentary writes itself, from the evidence.

1. **Profit bridge.** Each line's effect on net profit, summed and checked against the total.
2. **Drivers named** on every bar: the new customer, the lost one, the account that jumped.
3. **P&L variance statement,** CY, PY, Δ and Δ% for every line.
4. **A comment on each line,** written from the partners, accounts and memos behind it. Click any row to drill in.

LENS 03

Four clicks from “revenue is up” to who.

The explorer is the P&L as a tree: section, group, G/L account, then the customers or vendors inside it. Each level carries its own variance, a status of favourable, unfavourable, new, stopped or flat, and a comment naming what sits underneath.

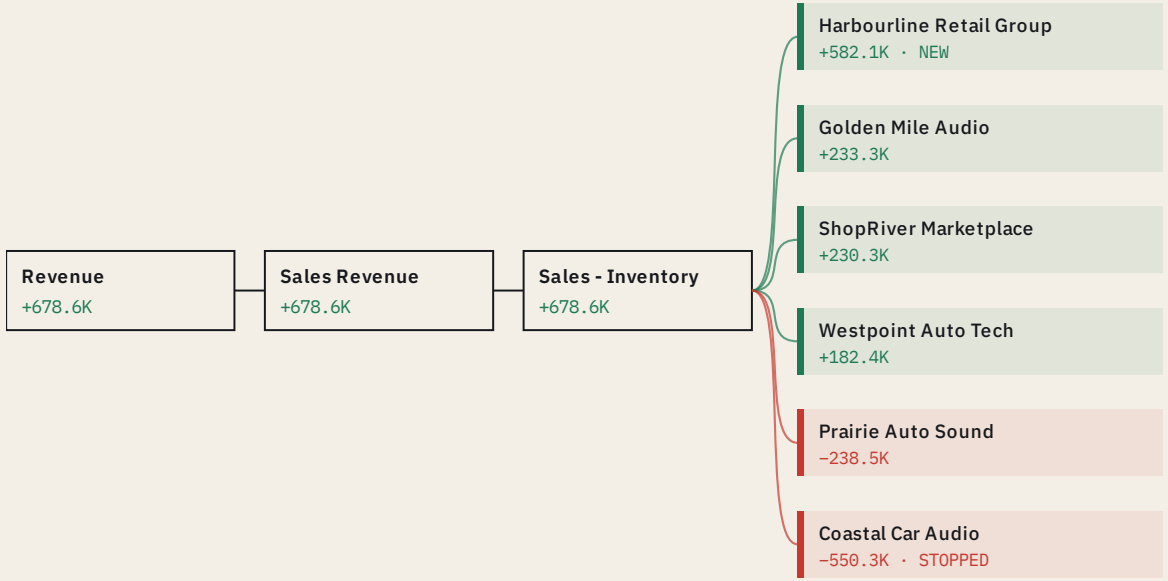
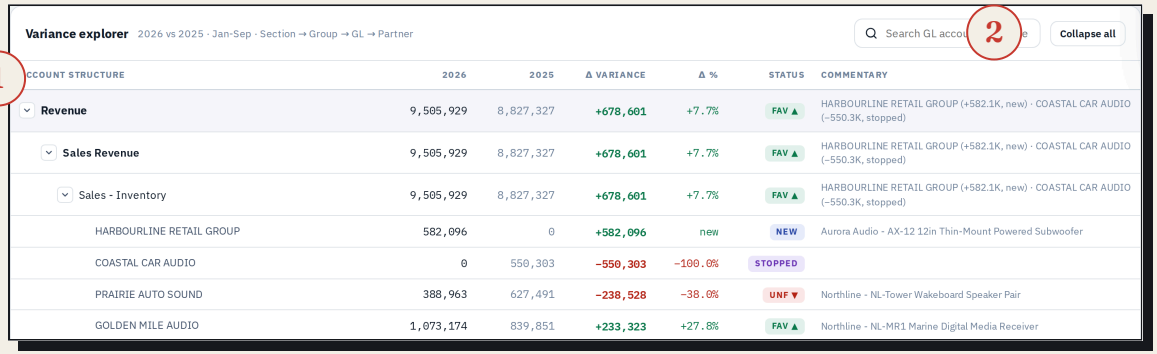


FIG. 6 · Sales growth of +678.6K, opened to the customers behind it: a new national account and a lost dealer nearly cancel out.



1. **Status** by the same rules everywhere, so NEW and STOPPED customers surface on their own.
2. **Search** any account or partner and the tree opens around the match.

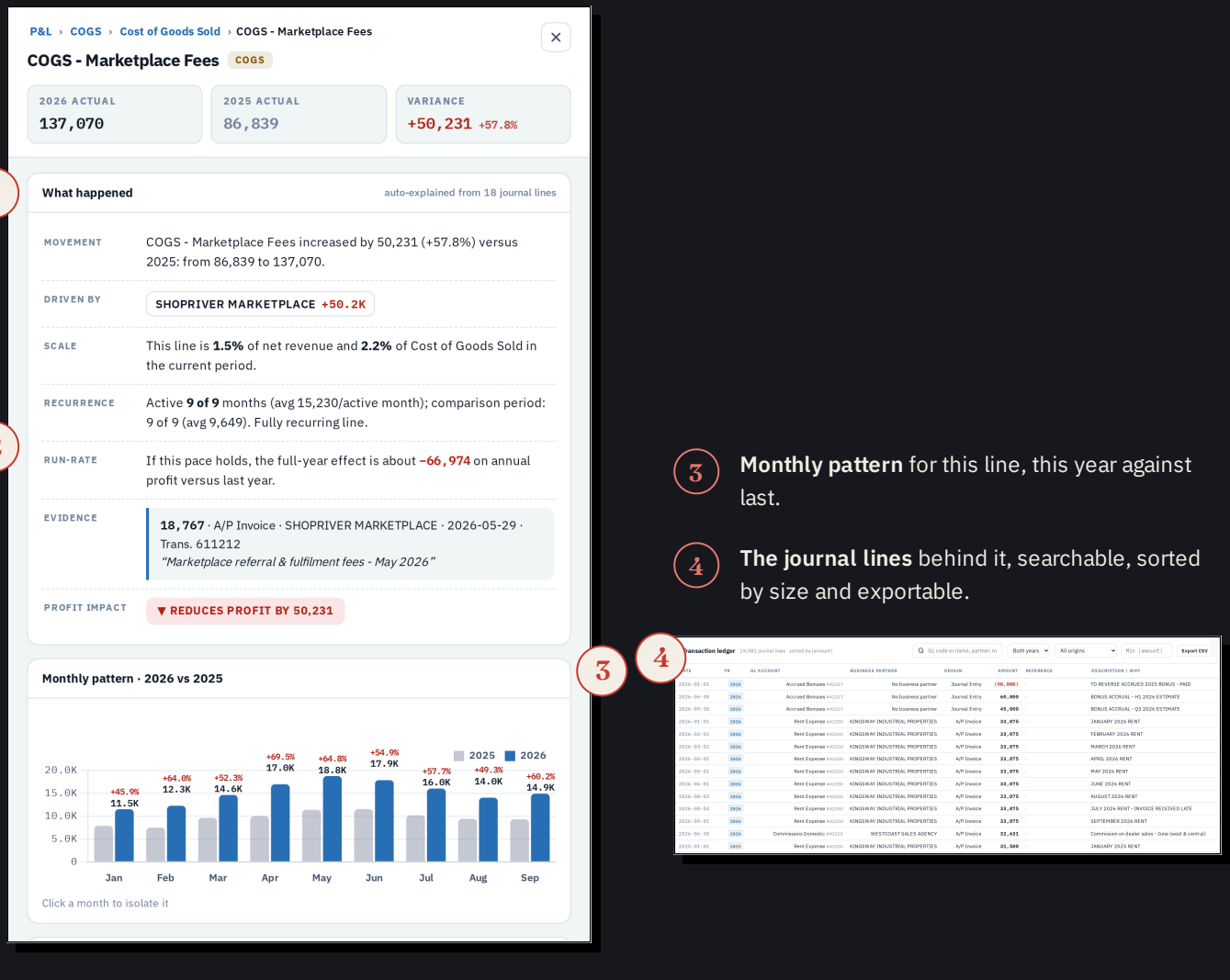
FIG. 7 · THE EXPLORER, OPENED TO SALES - INVENTORY

LENS 04 · ANATOMY OF A CLICK

Click any number. Read what happened.

Every card, bar, row and heat-map cell opens the same drawer. This one is marketplace fees, up 57.8%.

1. **What happened:** movement, the partner behind it, scale against revenue, how often it recurs and the full-year run-rate.
2. **Evidence:** the largest supporting line, with document, date and memo.
3. **Monthly pattern** for this line, this year against last.
4. **The journal lines** behind it, searchable, sorted by size and exportable.

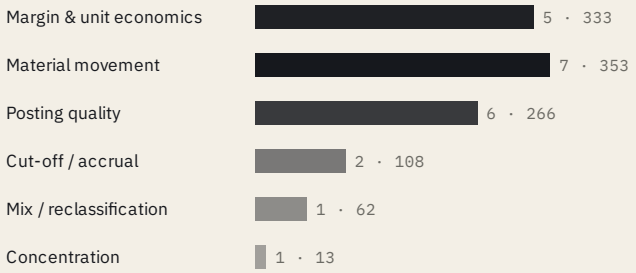


LENS 05 · THE CASE FILE

Thirteen tests. Run on every load.

The register looks for what reviewers look for: cut-off gaps, duplicates, round journals, credit balances in cost accounts, margin compression, concentration. Each finding gets a risk score from 0 to 100, its evidence and the next step.

RISK BY DIMENSION · FINDINGS · TOTAL SCORE



SIX OF 22 FINDINGS IN THE NORTHBRIDGE DEMO · SCORE OUT OF 100

74 · MARGIN
Gross margin, July
Fell to 31.7% from 37.5% a year earlier: −5.8pp.

71 · POSTING QUALITY
Rent charged twice in August
Same landlord, same amount, two invoices in one month.

65 · POSTING QUALITY
Licence keyed twice
14,960 software licence on two invoices in May.

65 · MATERIAL
Forex losses +159.6%
From 42,099 to 109,274 on USD supplier payments.

62 · CUT-OFF
July rent missing
Recurring account posted 8 of 9 months; July is empty.

46 · POSTING QUALITY
Round-sum bonus journals
Manual entries in round thousands: estimates to support.



FIG. 9 · THE AUDIT REGISTER. Read together, the two rent findings are one story: July's invoice arrived late and was booked in August. The tool doesn't hide either half.

LENS 06

Trading, or bookkeeping?

Before a variance is explained, it helps to know what kind of document moved it. Invoices and deliveries mean the business changed. Journals mean estimates, accruals and corrections.

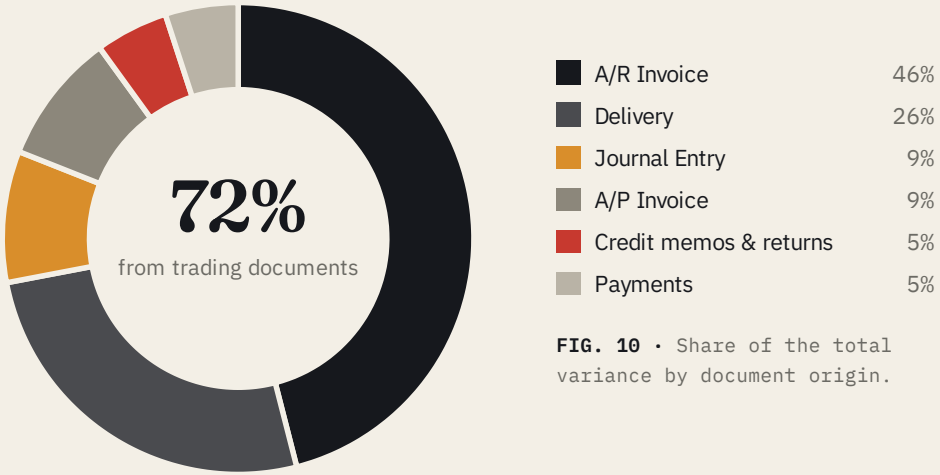


FIG. 10 · Share of the total variance by document origin.

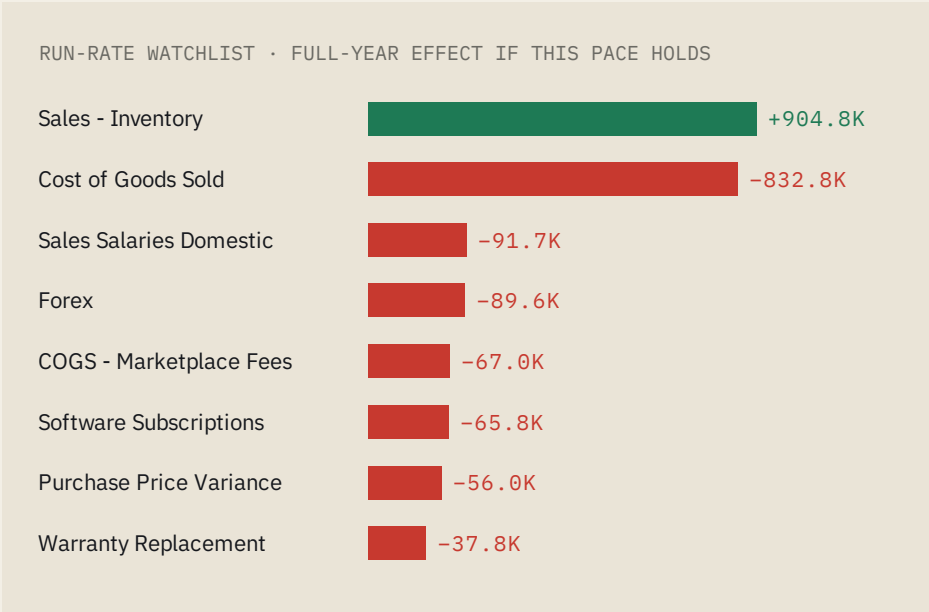


FIG. 11 · Sales add 904.8K a year at this pace; cost of goods takes 832.8K of it back.

1. **Manual JE pressure points** show where journals, not trading, are driving the period.
2. **Top drivers** by section and group, ranked by their share of the change.

FROM EXPORT TO REVIEW

Four steps. No IT project.

1

Run the query

One saved SAP Business One query returns P&L journal lines with section, group, account, partner, origin, memos and amount.

2

Drop the workbook

The data sheet is found by its columns. Years are detected and the complete months of the current year are selected.

3

Review

Start at the bridge and the audit register, follow the heatmap to the month, drill to the journal line.

4

Export and share

CSV from any view, drill-down or the audit pack. Next month, drop the new export.

YOUR DATA STAYS YOURS

A file on your computer or network drive. The workbook is read in the browser; nothing is uploaded or seen outside your business.

NO SERVER, NO INSTALL

Opens in Chrome or Edge. Sharing the analysis is sending a file.

MATERIALITY YOU SET

Defaults to 0.5% of revenue for the period; change it on screen and every test follows.

SEE IT ON YOUR OWN LEDGER

Bring one export. We'll show you your year.

WHAT YOU RECEIVE

01 The Variance Command Center as a single HTML file, with CSV export built in

02 The SAP Business One P&L journal-line query and the data template

03 Mapping of your P&L sections, groups and head accounts, and your branding

04 A demo file on fictional data for training and onboarding

05 Updates as the suite evolves, delivered as a replacement file

TrueSum

For pricing, multi-company licensing, or a guided demo using a sample of your own SAP export:

Shahzad

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	JAN	FEB	MAR	APR	MAY	JUN	JUL	AUG	SEP	TOTAL Δ
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Show Expenses			-27.4K						-24.8K	-52.2K
COGS - Marketplace Fees	+3.6K	+4.8K	+5.0K	+7.0K	+7.4K	+6.3K	+5.9K	+4.6K	+5.6K	+50.2K

TrueSum by GEMSEN

SCREENS AND CHARTS SHOW A FICTIONAL TRAINING DATASET. COMPANY, PARTNER AND ACCOUNT NAMES AND ALL AMOUNTS ARE ILLUSTRATIVE.
TRUESUM VARIANCE COMMAND CENTER IS DEVELOPED BY GEMSEN. MICROSOFT EXCEL AND SAP BUSINESS ONE ARE TRADEMARKS OF THEIR RESPECTIVE OWNERS.